

## Case Study: Boeing & Japan's Heavy Industries – A Partnership Built on Trust Background

Boeing partnered with Japanese heavy industries (Mitsubishi, Kawasaki, and Fuji) to develop key components for aircraft, including the 787 Dreamliner's composite wings.

**The Challenge:** Boeing was hesitant to share proprietary composite material technology, fearing IP risks. Japanese firms, in turn, were cautious about making large investments without long-term guarantees.

### Trust-Building Process:

- History of Collaboration**– Decades of successful partnerships laid the foundation for trust.
- Strategic Transparency** – Boeing shared critical knowledge under structured agreements.
- Risk & Investment Sharing** – Japanese firms built new facilities, backed by Boeing's long-term contracts.
- Joint Innovation** – Partners contributed to R&D, fostering ownership and quality.



**Outcome:** Japan now produces 35% of the 787 Dreamliner's airframe. Boeing secured a stable, high-quality supply chain. Trust led to faster production and deeper collaboration in future aircraft programs.

**Key Takeaways:** Trust fosters long-term partnerships, shared risks strengthen commitment, and collaboration drives innovation.

## 7. Know your Limits

Set clear boundaries early to maintain a healthy partnership. Recognize resource and capability limitations and communicate them transparently. Establishing trust through open discussions fosters understanding and ensures long-term success.

## 8. Adapt

Continuously assess and refine the partnership to stay aligned with market needs. Flexibility and adaptation drive sustainability and long-term growth.

